ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 16: **The Necklace (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** the characters suffer ten years for a worthless object	Irony of fate.
2	**(b)** foreshadowing	Hints at ruin.
3	**(b)** Do not cut your coat beyond your cloth	Beyond means.
4	**(c)** the truth about the necklace upsets the reader's expectation	Twist.
5	**(a)** the pity we feel for Mathilde's toil	Pity.
6	**(c)** the contrast between brief glory and long toil is stressed	Disproportion shows irony.
7	**(c)** the last revelation raises the irony to its highest point	Ending heightens irony.
8	**(a)** appearance versus reality	Proverb.
9	**(a)** the invitation to the ball	Inciting incident.
10	**(a)** ironic yet sympathetic	Both.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Mathilde suffers ten years (1) but the suffering is for a false cause and brings only worn looks, not obvious triumph, making it bitterly ironic (1).	1+1
12	It is vivid and almost admiring (1) while subtly implying the transience of glory (1).	1+1
13	It converts a small loss into a life-long debt (1) and so determines the whole second half of the story (1).	1+1
14	Mathilde's craving to rise above her class causes the loan (1) and class prejudice about dress and jewels drives her choices (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	The details of money, rooms and jobs give a realistic picture of life. The sudden twist reveals an ironic design. The combination makes the moral memorable.	1+1+1
16	A minor accident, the loss of a necklace, shapes a whole life. Yet the choices after the loss decide the outcome. Fate and choice work together.	1+1+1
17	The husband's quiet sacrifice and Madame Forestier's casual wealth would be less clear. The ironic distance would reduce. The narrator's wider view is needed for the twist.	1+1+1
	OR: Her vanity and silence caused the debt. But chance, class values and her husband's agreement also contributed. Responsibility is shared though her choices were decisive.	1+1+1
18	Social media and consumer culture encourage show. Many borrow to appear prosperous. The story warns against vanity and false status.	1+1+1
	OR: Honesty would have saved them. Fear and pride held them back. Ethics and prudence both favoured confession.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Define irony (1). Situational irony of the loss (1). Dramatic irony in the sacrifice (1). The final revelation (1). Evaluation (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Society's values of display (1). Individual's choices (1). Both interact (1). Evidence from text (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
20	Exposition: Mathilde's discontent (1). Rising action: ball and loss (1). Climax: replacement (1). Resolution: ten years and twist (1). How structure supports the moral (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Format (1). Shock (1). Searching ideas (1). Decision to replace (1). Mood of fear (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Calling Mathilde rich; she is a **middle-class** woman who dreams of luxury, married to a petty clerk in the Ministry of Education.
- Writing that the necklace was real; Madame Forestier's necklace was **paste**, worth at most 500 francs, so the sacrifice was needless.
- Mixing up the cost: the Loisels paid **36,000 francs** for the replacement and spent **ten years** repaying the debts.
- Not stating the moral: *pride and vanity* and not telling the truth lead to ruin; honesty at the start would have saved them.
- Saying Mathilde's husband was lazy; **M. Loisel** was loyal and gave her the 400 francs he had saved for a gun.
- Spelling slips: *Mathilde Loisel, Madame Forestier, necklace, francs, ball*; and missing the ironic end.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 16: **The Necklace (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** it lets action speak and keeps the tone restrained	Economy.
2	**(a)** Madame Forestier never suspected the necklace was lost until told	Implied.
3	**(d)** it shows how people are judged by show rather than worth	Critique.
4	**(b)** ironically true in material terms but they gained character	Nuanced.
5	**(d)** inverted third conditional	Inversion.
6	**(a)** entitled	Entitlement.
7	**(d)** False pride and vanity can bring ruin	Moral.
8	**(c)** social satire	Social critique.
9	**(d)** false identity	She borrows a status.
10	**(c)** does not value display as Mathilde does	Casual about show.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Pride makes people conceal mistakes (1) and concealment multiplies the cost of those mistakes (1).	1+1
12	It stands for the fall from pretended luxury to real poverty (1) and for the cramped consequences of vanity (1).	1+1
13	She can lend jewels freely and not check them (1) and her wealth lets the story contrast casual luxury with Mathilde's toil (1).	1+1
14	He shows loyalty and sacrifice (1) but joins in hiding the loss, sharing the fault of concealment (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	It appears at the key moments: borrowed, worn, lost, replaced, returned and revealed as paste. At each stage it shifts meaning from glamour to burden to illusion. The recurring motif unifies the plot.	1+1+1
16	Both end with a twist that reverses expectation. In one, a thief is cheated; in the other, a vain woman toils for a fake. Both teach caution about appearances and trust.	1+1+1
17	Mathilde borrows to look rich for a night. The debt deprives her of her youth and comfort. The story shows the price of appearances.	1+1+1
	OR: Labour first seems degrading to Mathilde. Later it becomes her strength and pride. The story respects honest work while criticising idleness of dreams.	1+1+1
18	The revelation that the necklace was paste recasts everything. The earlier sacrifice becomes tragic irony. The ending fixes the moral in the reader's mind.	1+1+1
	OR: It stresses the long and heavy price. It marks a whole phase of life. It sharpens the final irony.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Introduction (1). Mathilde's pride (1). Consequences (1). Modern examples (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Husband's sacrifice (1). Mathilde's hard work (1). Detail of hardship (1). Final shock (1). Overall effect (1).	2+2+1
20	Both change through experience (1). Hari by trust, Mathilde by loss (1). Hari's change is chosen, Mathilde's forced (1). Both gain strength (1). Verdict (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Title and author (1). Summary (1). Strengths (1). Weaknesses (1). Recommendation (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Calling Mathilde rich; she is a **middle-class** woman who dreams of luxury, married to a petty clerk in the Ministry of Education.
- Writing that the necklace was real; Madame Forestier's necklace was **paste**, worth at most 500 francs, so the sacrifice was needless.
- Mixing up the cost: the Loisels paid **36,000 francs** for the replacement and spent **ten years** repaying the debts.
- Not stating the moral: *pride and vanity* and not telling the truth lead to ruin; honesty at the start would have saved them.
- Saying Mathilde's husband was lazy; **M. Loisel** was loyal and gave her the 400 francs he had saved for a gun.
- Spelling slips: *Mathilde Loisel, Madame Forestier, necklace, francs, ball*; and missing the ironic end.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 16: **The Necklace (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** make the loss concrete and realistic	Realism.
2	**(d)** honest admission would have preserved their dignity and savings	Insight.
3	**(a)** stark and ironic	Stark.
4	**(b)** a toughened but diminished person	Transformation.
5	**(a)** a rise and fall pattern with a twist	Rise and fall.
6	**(a)** loyal	Loyal.
7	**(c)** illusion and reality	Mirror structure.
8	**(d)** the Loisels do not simply ask Madame Forestier to examine the necklace	Plot plausibility.
9	**(c)** the loss would have been revealed as small	Counterfactual.
10	**(c)** Mathilde told Forestier that she had replaced her necklace.	Pronoun and tense.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	It shows how fate and folly can ruin people (1) but also shows human endurance, so it is not wholly pessimistic (1).	1+1
12	Clues such as haste to hide the loss prepare it (1) while the paste revelation is unexpected, giving both satisfaction and shock (1).	1+1
13	Through exact figures and domestic detail (1) and plain narration of events without sentiment (1).	1+1
14	He shows Mathilde's faults first (1) then her courage in adversity, shifting sympathy gradually (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	The husband is practical and content, the wife restless and ambitious. His loyalty contrasts with her vanity. The contrast deepens the moral.	1+1+1
16	If Mathilde had told the truth, she would not have suffered. This is the third conditional referring to the past.	1+1+1
17	She speaks without shame. She finds pride in having paid the debt. Yet the revelation also destroys the meaning of her struggle.	1+1+1
	OR: It lets the narrator show Mathilde's dreams and the husband's efforts. It also allows ironic comment. The reader sees more than the characters do.	1+1+1
18	Mathilde, who wanted jewels, borrowed a necklace and lost it. A relative clause and coordination join the sentences.	1+1+1
	OR: Pity for the long suffering; impatience at the vanity and silence that started it. The mixed response is the author's aim. It makes her a human character.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Husband's love and sacrifice (1). Wife's discontent (1). Shared burden (1). Role of honesty (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Do not live beyond means (1). Avoid debt (1). Be honest in dealings (1). Value work (1). Content is better than show (1).	2+2+1
20	Clear opening (1). Borrowing (1). Loss or problem (1). Efforts (1). Twist ending (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Return the necklace (1). Continue unhappy (1). Remain in modest comfort (1). Possible lesson learned in other ways (1). Compare with real ending (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Calling Mathilde rich; she is a **middle-class** woman who dreams of luxury, married to a petty clerk in the Ministry of Education.

- Writing that the necklace was real; Madame Forestier's necklace was **paste**, worth at most 500 francs, so the sacrifice was needless.
- Mixing up the cost: the Loisels paid **36,000 francs** for the replacement and spent **ten years** repaying the debts.
- Not stating the moral: *pride and vanity* and not telling the truth lead to ruin; honesty at the start would have saved them.
- Saying Mathilde's husband was lazy; **M. Loisel** was loyal and gave her the 400 francs he had saved for a gun.
- Spelling slips: *Mathilde Loisel, Madame Forestier, necklace, francs, ball*; and missing the ironic end.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND